

JTMUN XII

UNSC Study Guide

The Committee

The United Nations Security Council is one of the six major organs of the United Nations and is also the most executive organ of the United Nations. The Security Council holds primary responsibility for international peace and security. It has 15 members, each with one vote, and every UN member state is bound by its decisions under the Charter. The Council determines threats to the peace and acts of aggression, urges peaceful settlement of disputes, and, when necessary, imposes sanctions or authorizes force. In the United Nations Charter, under Chapter VII of the UN Charter, the Security Council is authorized to find out any threat to international peace, breach of that peace, and respond by using military force when necessary.

Five permanent members, the **P5** (China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, the United States), hold the **veto**. Under Article 27(3), substantive resolutions require the concurring votes of all five. One negative vote from any of them kills a resolution outright. An abstention does not. The great powers demanded the veto as the price of creating the UN. It was established in 1945, and the Soviet Union first used it in 1946.

The Topic

“Freedom and fear are at war. These terrorists kill not merely to end lives, but to disrupt and end a way of life. They follow in the path of fascism, and Nazism, and totalitarianism. This country will define our times, not be defined by them. *Either you are with us, or you are with the terrorists.*”

— George Bush

Special Rules of Procedure:

Clause 1: Rules Governing The Veto

1.1 Each P5 country may only exercise the use of the veto thrice during the course of the conference

1.2 If at any point in the committee a motion is raised and passed with a 2/3rd majority, the veto can be suspended for any P5 country for an indefinite amount of time

CRISIS RULES OF PROCEDURE

Private Directives

Private Directives are a mechanism for ambassadors present in the Security Council to take actions in response to crisis updates. Each ambassador is assigned a specific portfolio; beyond which, they cannot exercise any powers. The portfolio of ambassadors is assigned by the government of the representative, so ambassadors cannot take actions that cannot be practically implemented by the powers assigned to them by their governments. Deputed ambassadors can write the private directives in a specific format attached below:

Sample Private Directive

Crisis Note Arc A #9 (Contact with NYT editor and gaining PR support through American correspondents)

To: Joseph Kan (Editor-in-Chief, NYT)

Dear Kan,

In my current capacity as the leader of the Syrian Liberation Army, and in light of the recent use of chemical weapons by the Syrian Arab Armed Forces on protesters in Damascus, alongside the failure of the Starmer-Macron Commission to provide tangible guarantees of independence and the continuing violation of Syrians' right to self-determination, it is highly important that the free press report on these occurrences to mobilize public opinion and hold your Western leaders accountable. I am very grateful that you reported on the travel barriers and sanctions imposed by the British and the French to restrict membership of minority communities within our Congress, which affirmed my belief that your newspaper is a protector of rights. I request that you send a delegation of correspondents from your newspaper to Damascus to provide firsthand reporting of General Manaf Tlass's collusion with the French and heading of a paramilitary organization to massacre civilians wantonly. I provide a personal guarantee of safety for these correspondents, as they will be housed near Marjah Square within Damascus at the Continental Hotel. I very much look forward to their arrival. Let me know when it is possible so I can carry out suitable arrangements for arrival and accommodations.

Yours truly, Sardar Mohammed Reza (Chief Syrian Liberation Army)

Side note to crisis staff: This crisis note will be followed by Crisis Note Arc # 10; please refer to that as well. Both these notes are supposed to be implemented in confluence.

Written in Session-5:15 pm-5:31 pm

Crisis Notes

Crisis notes are a subsection of private directives where ambassadors can take actions that they want to keep anonymous and don't want to be announced by the crisis staff. Crisis Notes follow a similar pattern to Private Directives, and acceptance and rejection of the note will be communicated to the ambassadors via the crisis staff in private.

Side Note for delegates: A series of Private Directives or Crisis Notes, which are sent for implementation of a particular goal, will be referred to as Crisis Arcs, which shall be numbered, along with the short-term objective of the Private Directive/Crisis Note stated, alongside the long-term goal of the Crisis Arc shall be stated.

Press Releases

Press Releases are a mechanism for ambassadors in the Security Council to make a statement or present a stance on crisis updates or any actions they are taking or want to take. All actions stated in an accepted Press Release will be announced; however, acceptance of a Press Release does not make the mentioned act implementable, as any actions taken by ambassadors in committee will be implemented only if done through an accepted Crisis Directive. Deputed ambassadors can write the Press Releases in a specific format attached below:

Sample Press Release:

Press Release A#1 By: Sardar Mohammed Reza

“In my capacity as the Chief of the Syrian Liberation Army, I hereby announce the following territories under the control of my organisation: Strait of Hormuz, Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Strait of Malacca, Strait of Gibraltar, and the Bering Strait. For the recommencement of international trade by sea, I demand the immediate rejection of the Starmer-Macron commission by the Heads of State of all permanent members of the Security Council, along with the introduction of new reforms to include the recommencement of the Syrian National Congress; for the discussion of new prospects of Syrian Independence from the Bashar al-Assad regime, and the subsequent setup of an International Tribunal for the prosecution of the members of the Al-Assad regime. The Syrian National Congress shall be chaired by the descendants of Mohammed Izzat Darwaza, the first General Secretary of the Syrian National Congress convened in 1919, to honor the legacy of the Darwaza Family for their sacrifices made for initial Syrian Independence.”

Side Note for delegates: A Press Release like this, if accepted, will be announced to the members of the Security Council, and the release serves as an official declaration from the government of a country to the members of the Security Council. (Delegates may add their plan

of action in their Press Releases, but the implementation is only practical if approved by the crisis staff via a crisis directive)

Public Directive

Public Directives are a means to achieve a documented resolution within a Crisis Committee. Each Representative or sponsor of a bloc is allowed to write all mechanised Clauses required to achieve said framework. A Public Directive is not meant to be only the final resolution presented to the Committee; instead, it can be presented on various occasions depending on the status of the committee. Do note that this is unlike either a Working paper or Draft Resolutions, as it does not have strict formatting rules and is not bound to be presented on only one occasion.

Sample Public Directive

Public Directive 1.1

Sponsors: Vincent Lo, Zhou Nan

Signatories: Li Ka-Shing, Henry Fok, Lu Ping

1. Working with the taxation bureau of the People's Republic of China, establishes a 10% cut in income taxes to any Chinese citizen who establishes a business in Hong Kong that meets the following requirements:
 - a. Employs a minimum of 50 Hong Kong residents
 - b. Does not violate the moral ideology of the PRC.
2. In conjunction with the trade bureau, it reduces the import tariff by 10% for all goods produced in Hong Kong and transported to the PRC.

HISTORY OF 9/11

The World Trade Center

The World Trade Center was a big commercial district in Lower Manhattan, New York City, and its two most well-known buildings—the World Trade Center Tower, also called the North Tower (WTC 1), and the World Trade Center Tower 2, also known as the South Tower (WTC 2)—were both 110 stories tall and had become the symbol of international trade. The towers served as symbols of both New York City and the economic strength of America. Their significance went beyond their size since they also showed America's influence in international trade, a fact which unfortunately made them a favourite target for people who opposed Western countries.

The Port Authority of New York and New Jersey carried out the development, while the architectural design was done by the architect Minoru Yamasaki. Construction started in 1966, the North Tower was opened in 1972 and the buildings were officially dedicated in April 1973. The North Tower was approximately 1,368 feet high and the South Tower about 1,362 feet, and for a short period they were the tallest buildings in the world. The site consisted of about sixteen acres and contained seven buildings in all, including a hotel, a large plaza and the smaller 7 World Trade Center, which was completed in 1987. According to figures frequently quoted by the Port Authority, around 50,000 people were employed in the complex and about 140,000 visitors went through it on a normal day. Hundreds of companies from many countries were based there, among them major financial firms. The South Tower had a public observation deck and the restaurant Windows on the World was located at the top of the North Tower. In July 2001 the Port Authority gave a 99-year lease on the towers to the private developer Larry Silverstein, thus placing the complex in the midst of a change of control on the day of the attack.

The 1993 World Trade Center Bombing:

The World Trade Center had previously been the target of an attack before September 11. On February 26, 1993, a bomb was detonated in the parking garage underneath the buildings and as a result six people died and more than 1,000 were injured. The explosion caused considerable damage and caused thousands to have to leave the complex. The bombing was carried out by Islamist extremists under the leadership of Ramzi Yousef, who was also involved in the 9/11 attacks. Although the attack did not bring the Twin Towers down, it did show that the World Trade Center was already regarded in the United States as a target for terrorism and was seen by many as a warning of the more devastating attack that would later take place.

The bomb was a homemade explosive weighing about 1,200 pounds and was carried in a van that had been rented and left parked on the B-2 level of the garage under the North Tower. It detonated just after noon and produced a crater that was several stories deep. The people who had plotted it were a small group of men, comprising Mohammed Salameh, Nidal Ayyad, Mahmoud Abouhalima, Ahmad Ajaj and Eyad Ismoil. Salameh was caught when he went back to get the deposit on the van that had been rented. Yousef escaped to Pakistan on the night of the attack and was apprehended in Islamabad in February 1995. He was convicted in 1997 and given a sentence of life imprisonment. Sheikh Omar Abdel Rahman, an Egyptian religious figure, was found guilty in 1995 of seditious conspiracy in connection with a broader plan to attack New York landmarks. Yousef had also been involved in the 1995 Bojinka plot in Manila, which intended to bomb a number of airliners over the Pacific at the same time, and his uncle, Khalid

Sheikh Mohammed, later became the principal planner of 9/11. The 9/11 Commission noted that the United States treated the 1993 attack primarily as a criminal matter to be dealt with in court rather than as the first step in a war, and that this influenced the way the government dealt with terrorism for the rest of the decade.

Al Qaeda's Threat

In the 1990s Osama bin Laden and al-Qaeda established a highly effective international terrorist network. They were able to recruit, train, and organize spies in many countries, including in the Western nations. By the end of the 1990s and into the 2000s, al-Qaeda had turned into a major global terrorist threat. Afghanistan became a dangerous place for the Western countries, particularly the United States and Israel, since al-Qaeda was carrying out its operations there with the protection of the Taliban. The danger was no longer coming just from one group but was instead coming from a country that was strongly opposed to the West and which had wide-ranging spy networks, as shown by the bombing of the USS Cole. The fact that the country had an anti-Western attitude, together with the United States having played a role in the creation of both al-Qaeda and the Taliban, made the situation a major international issue.

The organisation al-Qaeda was formed in 1988 in Peshawar, Pakistan, from a group of Arab volunteers who had gone to fight the Soviets. The original members were bin Laden, the Palestinian cleric Abdullah Azzam and, subsequently, the Egyptian doctor Ayman al-Zawahiri, whose group, the Egyptian Islamic Jihad, officially merged with al-Qaeda in 2001. Bin Laden resided in Sudan from 1991 to 1996, had his Saudi citizenship revoked in 1994 and was expelled from Sudan in 1996 as a result of international pressure, after which he went back to Afghanistan. The Commission speaks of an organisation that has a leadership council, committees dealing with military, financial, media and religious matters, and a network of training camps. It states that between 10,000 and 20,000 men went through bin Laden's camps between 1996 and 2001. The Commission estimates that al-Qaeda's annual budget was about 30 million dollars, most of which came from private donors and charities, and found no proof that any government provided it with funding.

The reasons that Bin Laden gave were the fact that American troops were present in Saudi Arabia following the 1991 Gulf War, the sanctions imposed on Iraq, and U.S. support for Israel. In August 1996 he declared war on Americans in the Arabian Peninsula, and in February 1998 he together with Zawahiri and others issued a fatwa stating that it was a duty on all Muslims to kill both civilian and military Americans. Six months later, on 7 August 1998, al-Qaeda exploded

bombs at the U.S. embassies in Nairobi, Kenya, and Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, killing over 200 people, the majority of whom were Africans. The United States responded on 20 August by launching cruise missile attacks on camps in Afghanistan and a factory in Sudan. In December 1999 an al-Qaeda agent, Ahmed Ressaam, was caught at the Canadian border with explosives meant for Los Angeles airport, one of a number of "millennium" plots which were foiled. On 12 October 2000 suicide bombers in a small boat struck the USS Cole in the port of Aden, Yemen, killing 17 American sailors. The operation was carried out by al-Qaeda itself, and the Taliban's role was to provide the group with a safe base.

The Taliban regime was headed by Mullah Mohammed Omar and had recognition from just three countries: Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates. It ignored numerous requests to turn over bin Laden. The United Nations Security Council took action on this matter before 2001. In December 1998 Resolution 1214 was passed, requiring the Taliban to cease providing asylum to terrorists. In October 1999 Resolution 1267 was adopted, calling for the surrender of bin Laden and imposing sanctions on the Taliban. In December 2000 Resolution 1333 was passed, introducing an arms embargo, demanding that the training camps be closed and instructing the freezing of bin Laden's assets. The final major opponent of the Taliban, Ahmad Shah Massoud of the Northern Alliance, was murdered on 9 September 2001 by al-Qaeda agents who were pretending to be journalists, two days prior to the freeze date.

Creation of Al Qaeda and The Taliban

The rise of al-Qaeda and the Taliban is closely connected to the involvement of countries such as the U.S., Pakistan, Afghanistan, and the USSR/Russia. Upon the Soviet Union's invasion of Afghanistan, the United States, Pakistan and Saudi Arabia provided money and weapons to Afghan resistance groups. The Pakistani Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) was the main route through which American aid was sent. This assistance enabled fundamentalist groups and militant networks to emerge, leading eventually to the formation of al-Qaeda. Although the United States did not directly set up or finance al-Qaeda, its actions did help cause the organisation to come into being. Following the withdrawal of the Soviet army, Afghanistan slipped into a civil war and the Taliban gained control of Kabul in 1996. The new government remained closely aligned with Pakistan and bin Laden and the al-Qaeda leaders established camps in areas under Taliban control. At the same time, the United States started to regard bin Laden as a serious security threat. The fact that Pakistan had played a role in the Taliban's rise, the fact that the U.S. had previously supported anti-Soviet fighters whose support had by accident helped to create these groups, and the complicated regional politics involving Saudi Arabia, Iran, India and Russia all contributed significantly to the crisis.

In December 1979 the Soviet Union launched an invasion of Afghanistan with the aim of supporting a communist government in Kabul. The American covert operation which backed the resistance, called Operation Cyclone, was initiated by President Carter and increased considerably during the presidency of Reagan, with funding from Saudi Arabia matching that of the United States. Pakistan's military ruler, General Zia-ul-Haq, insisted that all aid should pass through the ISI, the organisation which decided which Afghan groups should receive weapons and which preferred the more Islamist factions. The fighters received shoulder-fired Stinger missiles from 1986. The Arab volunteers, on the other hand, were organised by Azzam's Services Office in Peshawar and were mostly financed by private donors from the Gulf, not by the CIA. The 9/11 Commission found no evidence that the United States had ever given direct funding to bin Laden, which is the reason why the statement regarding American responsibility should be presented as an indirect one. The Geneva Accords were signed in 1988 and the last Soviet troops withdrew in February 1989. The communist government in Kabul remained in power until 1992, after which the various mujahideen commanders turned against each other and fought in a bloody civil war that destroyed Kabul and left the country without law.

The Taliban, which translates as "students", came about in the religious schools situated along the border between Afghanistan and Pakistan and gained power in Kandahar under Mullah Omar in 1994. They captured Kandahar at the end of 1994, took Herat in 1995 and seized Kabul on 27 September 1996, and by 2001 had control over about nine tenths of the country. Their regime was founded on a strict interpretation of Deobandi Islam. They prohibited education for girls and most forms of employment for women, and in March 2001 they destroyed the large Buddha statues at Bamiyan even though there was worldwide protest. Pakistan provided them with money, fuel and advisers since it wished to have a friendly government in Kabul and wanted to gain strategic depth with regard to India. Saudi Arabia supported them until it severed relations in 1998, after they had refused to hand over bin Laden. Iran, because its Shia government was opposed to them, almost entered war in 1998 after Taliban fighters killed Iranian diplomats in Mazar-i-Sharif. India and Russia supported the Northern Alliance, while the Central Asian states were concerned about the spread of Taliban-type militancy. Bin Laden himself returned to Afghanistan in May 1996 and formed an alliance with Mullah Omar, which enabled al-Qaeda to operate its camps in Taliban territory.

THE 11 SEPTEMBER 2001 TIMELINE

Before the attacks

26 February 1993

World Trade Center bombing.

1990s

Osama bin Laden and al-Qaeda develop an international terrorist network.

1996

Bin Laden moves to Afghanistan, where the Taliban controls much of the country.

1998

Al-Qaeda carries out bombings against U.S. embassies in Kenya and Tanzania.

12 October 2000

The USS Cole is attacked in Yemen.

9 September 2001

Ahmad Shah Massoud is assassinated by attackers posing as journalists.

11 September 2001

7:59 a.m.

American Airlines Flight 11 departs Boston for Los Angeles.

8:14 a.m.

United Airlines Flight 175 departs Boston for Los Angeles.

8:42 a.m.

United Airlines Flight 93 departs Newark for San Francisco.

8:46:40 a.m.

Flight 11 strikes the North Tower of the World Trade Center.

9:03:11 a.m.

Flight 175 strikes the South Tower.

9:37:46 a.m.

Flight 77 strikes the Pentagon.

9:57 a.m.

Passengers aboard Flight 93 begin attempting to regain control of the aircraft.

9:59 a.m.

The South Tower collapses.

10:03:11 a.m.

Flight 93 crashes near Shanksville, Pennsylvania.

10:28 a.m.

The North Tower collapses.

HOW THE ATTACKS UNFOLDED

American Airlines Flight 11

American Airlines Flight 11 was a Boeing 767 flying from Boston to Los Angeles.

It collided with the North Tower of the World Trade Center at approximately 8:46:40 a.m.

As a result of the collision, there was extensive structural damage and fires. The extent of the operation at this stage was not yet known.

The second aircraft attack would soon reveal this.

United Airlines Flight 175

United Airlines Flight 175 was flying from Boston to Los Angeles too.

It collided with the South Tower at approximately 9:03 a.m.

This was done only seventeen minutes after the collision of the first aircraft with the North Tower. Two commercial aircraft have now intentionally collided with two skyscrapers in New York.

There was no doubt about the coordination of the attack.

The Collapse of the Twin Towers

The towers did not collapse instantly when hit.

The structural damage was created by the aircraft collision and the fires weakened the structural integrity of the components. The South Tower collapsed at approximately 9:59 a.m. The North Tower collapsed at approximately 10:28 a.m.

American Airlines Flight 77

The attacks were not restricted to New York.

American Airlines Flight 77 was flying from Washington Dulles International Airport to Los Angeles. At approximately 9:37:46 a.m., it crashed into the Pentagon in Arlington, Virginia.

The Pentagon is the headquarters of the U.S. Department of Defense. Therefore, the operation has also attacked a major American military organization along with the World Trade Center.

The level of the Crisis greatly increased due to terrorizing a state military Headquarter.

United Airlines Flight 93

United Airlines Flight 93 was flying from Newark to San Francisco.

The passengers and crew found out about the attacks through the phone 06.

The Flight was meant to attack Washington D.C but the crew and passengers Compromised the mission after being informed of the hijacker's true intent

The Four Targets and the Strategic Logic of the Attack:

The four aircraft attacks formed one coordinated operation rather than four unrelated incidents. The first two aircraft struck the World Trade Center in New York City. The third struck the Pentagon in Arlington, Virginia. The fourth aircraft crashed in Pennsylvania before reaching its presumed target in Washington, D.C. The targets represented different dimensions of American national power. The World Trade Center represented America's economic and commercial influence. The Pentagon represented American military power. The presumed Washington target represented the political leadership of the United States. The operation therefore sought to inflict simultaneous damage upon the economic, military, and political symbols of American power. The geographical distribution of the attacks also demonstrated the unprecedented reach of the operation.

Within approximately 77 minutes, hijacked aircraft had been used against targets in New York City and the Washington metropolitan area, while a fourth aircraft crashed in Pennsylvania.

The Significance of the Attack

This showed that even a Non state terrorist group could conduct such a complicated mission across international boundaries to effectively attack the territories of a major world power.

The mission involved international systems like aviation, travel, communication, funding, and training that essentially led to much higher security measures in international air travel.

This presented an entirely new form of security problem when compared to a traditional attack by one nation against another and was much more widely condemned as well.

It is because of this that the international community faced issues like terrorism, sovereignty, self-defense, state responsibility and domestic security.

Immediate Impacts:

The attacks caused catastrophic loss of life. According to the 9/11 Commission, more than 2,600 people were killed at the World Trade Center, 125 people were killed at the Pentagon, and 256 people died aboard the four aircraft. The attacks therefore resulted in the deaths of thousands of people in a matter of hours. The destruction of the Twin Towers also affected the surrounding area of Lower Manhattan, while the attack on the Pentagon struck the centre of the American defense establishment. The attacks produced an immediate national crisis in the United States

and an international security crisis whose consequences extended far beyond the locations directly attacked.

Potential US Policy Shift:

The attacks of 11 September 2001 are likely to cause a major transformation in US security and foreign policy. The scale and coordination of the attacks has demonstrated that the United States is facing a threat that cannot be met through conventional policing alone. Washington may thus move toward more domestic security, more intelligence, tougher surveillance, and a wider international war on terrorism.

Possible Legislative Action

The U.S. may be considering a sweeping anti-terrorism bill or a broad security law that would grant federal authorities greater powers to investigate and prevent terrorist activity. Such legislation could give security agencies more powers to monitor suspected terrorist networks, investigate financial links, gather intelligence and co-ordinate information between different government departments.

Any such legislation would likely be framed as an emergency response to the attacks. But it could also open a debate on how much extraordinary security powers should be granted and whether more government authority might infringe on privacy and civil liberties.

Enhanced Domestic Security Steps

There is likely to be a big increase in domestic security. Airports, borders, ports, military installations, government buildings and other strategic sites could be placed on high alert. Particular attention is likely to be paid to aviation security, as the attacks have shown that civilian aircraft can be deliberately turned into weapons.

The United States can also step-up passenger screening, limit access to sensitive facilities, enhance security patrols and improve coordination between federal, state and local authorities. Emergency services could stay on high alert in case the attacks are part of a wider operation.

Diversification of Intelligence and Espionage Activities

The attacks are likely to result in a major expansion of American intelligence operations. Security agencies will need to establish who planned the attacks, how the hijackers were organized, where their support networks are and whether more operatives are still active.

The United States may therefore step up intelligence gathering, surveillance and covert counter-terrorism operations at home and abroad. More focus could be given to communications, financial transactions, travel patterns and links between suspected members of terrorist organizations.

The term 'espionage' may therefore become increasingly relevant to the crisis, although the more precise policy expectation would be an expansion of intelligence gathering, surveillance and covert counter-terrorism operations.

International Cooperation Against Terrorism

The US may also try to seek much-needed cooperation from other countries' governments. Information sharing between intelligence agencies about suspected terrorists, identification by governments of terrorist groups within their jurisdictions, as well as their attempts to deny financial and logistical help to these groups may all be included in the US requests.

Extradition or prosecution of suspects and freezing assets associated with terrorist organizations may also be requested by the US government. In essence, it would mean making counterterrorism an international rather than purely American affair.

Global Campaign Against Terrorism

The events may signal the start of a very broad campaign against terrorism around the world. Instead of seeing individual acts of terrorism as one-off criminal actions, the United States may try to identify and destroy the broader organisations that plan and implement such actions.

Such a campaign might include diplomatic coercion, intelligence operations, economic coercion, law enforcement cooperation and possibly military intervention if the people responsible or their base is identified. Exactly how such a campaign will take shape is unclear as of 11 September since the identity, location and international connections of those responsible are not known yet.

Coercion of Foreign Governments Supporting Terrorist Organizations

If evidence shows that another government knowingly protects, trains, funds or allows terrorist organizations on its soil, the US may coerce this government to stop such activities.

This may include arrests of suspects, closure of terrorist operations and prevention of use of their territories for future attacks.

Such an approach would signal a big shift in international relations because states will be judged according to their willingness to join the international effort against terrorism.

Military Dimension

A world war on terrorism may potentially move beyond intelligence and policing in the future. If the USA identifies any terrorist organizations or infrastructures outside its borders and holds them accountable for the present terrorist acts, then military strikes against those targets might be considered.

This kind of military response will pose difficult questions before the Security Council with regard to such issues as self-defense, sovereignty, proportionality, necessity, and use of force

against non-state actors. The Security Council will also have to address itself to the issue of collective international action and the rules that should govern it.

The Emerging “With Us or With the Terrorists” Strategy

George Bush’s President of the United States of America’s declaration that “Either you are with us, or you are with the terrorists” gives rise to the hope of a more aggressive international strategy in relation to terrorism. States may find themselves under increasing pressure to prove whether they are ready to cooperate in stopping terrorist organizations or simply ignoring them.

Consequently, from the point of view of the USA, the attacks of today can result in a policy revolution that includes greater domestic security efforts, increased intelligence and surveillance, enhanced anti-terrorism laws, increased international cooperation and even global war against terrorist organizations. However, after 11 September 2001, the exact nature and scope of this revolution are to be determined by the USA and the international community based on additional information about these attacks.

KEY PERSONNEL

George W. Bush

As President of the United States, it fell to him to be the principal political voice in America’s response to the attacks. He was at a school in Florida when word of the events reached him; at the time he had been in office for under a year. Once he had departed the Sarasota school, he made his way to Air Force One and headed back to Washington in order to speak to the nation later that night.

Osama bin Laden

The founder and head of al-Qaeda, bin Laden was the driving force behind the organization and its most significant operations. Having established al-Qaeda in Peshawar back in August 1988, he eventually made his way to Afghanistan to work under the aegis of the Taliban. It is from there that the group put in place the major attacks on U.S. targets prior to September 2001, such as the 2000 assault on the USS Cole and the embassy bombings of 1998. With al-Qaeda running out of Afghanistan under Taliban cover, bin Laden was at the heart of the crisis

Andrew Card.

Andrew Card was the White House Chief of Staff under President George W. Bush. On 11th September 2001 Andrew Card told President Bush while he was visiting a school in Florida that

a second plane had hit the World Trade Center making it clear that the nation was facing an attack. Andrew Card then helped coordinate the White House response as the crisis unfolded.

Dick Cheney

In his capacity as Vice President, Cheney was moved to the Presidential Emergency Operations Center on 11 September to help steer the federal response. His background included a stint as a Wyoming Congressman and service as Secretary of Defense in the Gulf War. More recently, in May 2001, he had been tasked with overseeing domestic readiness in the event of an attack involving weapons of mass destruction.

Colin Powell

Secretary of State. A former Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff. His role is especially important for the international side of the American response. Before becoming Secretary of State he had served as Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff. Had played a major role in the Gulf War. During the attacks he was in Lima for the OAS assembly. Cut the visit short.

Donald Rumsfeld

Secretary of Defence. He was inside the Pentagon when it was struck and then returned to the National Military Command Center, where he helped manage the response. He had previously served as Secretary of Defence under President Ford. Had returned to the position under President Bush. He was inside the Pentagon when it was struck and then returned to the National Military Command Center.

Richard Myers

Senior U.S. Officer and acting Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff on 11 September. He was involved in the response and served as a senior military adviser. He had previously commanded NORAD and Space Command. On 11 September he became acting Chairman because General Hugh Shelton was airborne when the attacks began.

George Tenet

Director of the CIA since 1997. His role made him one of the U.S. Intelligence figures during the crisis. He had led the CIA since 1997. Had been retained from the Clinton administration. He had also worked on the Senate Intelligence Committee staff and at the National Security Council before becoming director.

Robert Mueller

FBI Director during the attacks. He was responsible for the investigation and the immediate law-enforcement response. He had been FBI Director for seven days when the attacks occurred. Before taking the post he had served as a Marine officer, a United States Attorney and head of the Justice Department's Criminal Division.

Khalid Sheikh Mohammed

A senior al-Qaeda. The main operational architect of the September 11 plot. He proposed the operation to bin Laden. Played a central role in selecting assigning and financing operatives. He had proposed the September 11 operation to bin Laden in 1996 with the plan later approved and reduced from a larger design. He had also been involved with the Bojinka plot with Ramzi Yousef, who carried out the 1993 World Trade Center bombing.

Ayman al-Zawahiri

Deputy emir of al-Qaeda. Leader of Egyptian Islamic Jihad. He was one of bin Laden's senior figures and an important part of the organization's leadership. He led Islamic Jihad before formally merging the organization into al-Qaeda in June 2001. He was one of bin Laden's advisers and helped shape al-Qaeda's focus on attacking the United States.

Mohammed Atef

Al-Qaeda military commander. He supervised training structures and was closely involved with the operation. Also known as Abu Hafs al-Masri, he had served as al-Qaeda's commander since 1996. He oversaw training and recruitment structures. Acted as an important link between al-Qaeda and the Taliban.

Mullah Mohammed Omar

Leader of the Taliban. His importance comes from the Taliban's control of Afghanistan and its protection of bin Laden. He founded the Taliban in Kandahar in 1994. Led it when its forces captured Kabul in 1996. He refused demands to surrender bin Laden making his government central to the crisis surrounding al-Qaeda's presence in Afghanistan.

Muhammad Atta

Pilot of American Airlines Flight 11. The main field leader of the operation. He coordinated the hijackers. Played a central role in planning the attack. He became the figure of the Hamburg cell and was later designated the field commander of the operation. He entered the United States in 2000 trained in Florida and played a role in coordinating the hijackers and the timing of the attacks.

Hani Hanjour

Pilot of American Airlines Flight 77 which struck the Pentagon. Unlike the Hamburg group he had travelled to the United States for years. Had obtained an FAA commercial pilot certificate in 1999. He was recruited into the plot in 2000 and continued flight training in Arizona and Maryland.

Marwan al-Shehhi

Pilot of United Airlines Flight 175 which struck the South Tower. He had moved to Hamburg on a scholarship from the United Arab Emirates and joined Atta's circle there. He later travelled to Afghanistan with the group. Trained alongside Atta, in Florida after entering the United States in 2000.

Ziad Jarrah

Pilot of United Airlines Flight 93 which crashed near Shanksville after passengers attempted to regain control. He studied aircraft engineering in Hamburg. Trained at a Florida flight school in 2000. He was part of the Hamburg group and later piloted Flight 93 which crashed near Shanksville after passengers attempted to regain control.

OTHER WORLD LEADERS

Ahmad Shah Massoud

He was the commander of the Northern Alliance and served as Defence Minister for the Rabbani government, which held Afghanistan's UN seat. Massoud had predicted a major attack was coming before he was assassinated on September 9th.

Vladimir Putin

The President of Russia. Russia had dealt with its own issues involving insurgencies and separatist groups, and he was among the first world leaders to speak with President Bush after the attacks.

Pervez Musharraf

President of Pakistan. Pakistan had previously recognized the Taliban government and had established connections with the Afghan movement. Given its location, Pakistan's role is particularly vital for any U.S. response concerning Afghanistan.